

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Political Science (BA)

Political Science involves the study of interesting and important topics about citizenship, government and politics. These topics include the influence of citizens on what government does, the scope, responsibilities and effectiveness of government itself, and the activities of both elected and appointed public officials. These topics are important parts of what political scientists know about American government and politics, comparative government and politics, international relations, political behavior, political economy, political institutions, and political theory. Political scientists and public administrators pay particular attention to the design, implementation, and evaluation of laws and public policies that may affect people's well-being.

The Political Science Program at The University of Texas at Dallas provides:

- the foundations for more advanced, graduate study of citizenship, government and politics in Political Science;
- the special core knowledge needed for subsequent professional education in law and public policy analysis;
- the opportunity to acquire useful skills for careers in federal, state, and local government, community service, educational and other nonprofit organizations, and business firms.

Bachelor of Arts in Political Science

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Patrick T. Brandt, Thomas L. Brunell, Euel W. Elliott, Jennifer S. Holmes, Robert C. Lowry, Banks P. Miller, Clint W. Peinhardt, Marianne C. Stewart

Associate Professor: Thomas Gray

Assistant Professors: Curtis Bram, Sivaram Cheruvu, Elías Cisneros, Natalia Lamberova, Marcelo Leal, Erin Litzow, Jonathan Pinckney, Lauren Santoro, Anton Sobolev, Pengfei Zhang

Professor Emeritus: Anthony M. Champagne, Paul Diehl, Edward J. Harpham

Professor of Instruction: Karl K. Ho

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government¹

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[CRIM 1301](#) Introduction to Criminal Justice

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 58 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 1 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[EPPS 1110](#) Critical Issues in the Social Sciences

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government¹

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government¹

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

Major Core Courses: 15 semester credit hours

Required Core Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[PSCI 3322](#) Constitutional Law

[PSCI 3333](#) Political Behavior

Choose three courses from the following: 9 semester credit hours

[PSCI 3301](#) Political Theory

[PSCI 3328](#) International Relations

[PSCI 3350](#) Comparative Politics

[PSCI 4329](#) Global Politics

[PSCI 3362](#) The American Political Institutions

Major Related Courses: 42 semester credit hours

42 semester credit hours Major and Related electives²

III. Elective Requirements: 20 semester credit hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower- and upper-division courses from any field of study.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor, 12 of which must be upper-division semester credit hours. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor.

Minor in Political Science

18 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

Upper-Division Courses: 12 semester credit hours

Any upper-division courses with a PSCI prefix except [PSCI 4V76](#), [PSCI 4V97](#), [PSCI 4V98](#) and [PSCI 4V99](#).

Certificates

Certificate in Public Service and Civic Leadership

12-15 semester credit hours

Students, of all majors, with an interest in public service have three different competitive pathways to experience working in the field in combination with rigorous coursework in civic engagement, policymaking, and leadership:

- The Archer Fellowship Program,
- The Texas Legislative Fellowship Program (TLFP)
- Initiative for Civic Leadership (ICL) at UT Dallas.

The Certificate in Public Service and Civic Leadership enables students to earn a credential that speaks to their dedication to civic engagement and highlights the coursework and internship they have completed.

Admission Requirements

Open only to UT Dallas majors who are fellows in the Archer Center, Texas Legislature Internship Program, or the Initiative for Civic Leadership.

- Cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher
- Sophomore, junior, or senior status (dependent on program)
- 24 hours of academic residency at UT Dallas
- Completion of core government requirements ([GOVT 2305](#) and [GOVT 2306](#))
- Application (including resume, personal statement, 500-word policy memo, and faculty recommendation)
- Interview

Certificate Requirements

Archer Fellowship Certificate: 15 Semester Credit Hours

The Archer Fellowship combines 9 credit hours of academic coursework with a (6-semester credit hour) internship in Washington, DC.

Students live and work side by side as they experience the nation's capital.

Course Requirements:

[PSCI 4370](#) Policy Making Process

[PSCI 4372](#) Advocacy and Politics

[PSCI 4373](#) Politics of National Memory

PSCI 4v76 Archer Center Washington Internship (6 Semester Credit Hours)

Texas Legislature Internship Program (TLFP) Certificate: 12 Semester Credit Hours

The TLFP combines 6 semester credit hours of academic course work with a 6-semester credit hour internship in the Texas State Capitol during the spring semester while the Legislature is in session.

Course Requirements:

[PSCI 4374](#) Policy Making in Austin

[PSCI 4375](#) Advocacy in the State Legislature

[PSCI 4398](#) Texas Legislative Fellowship Internship (6 Semester Credit Hours)

Initiative for Civic Leadership (ICL) Certificate: 12 Semester Credit Hours

The ICL combines 6 semester credit hours of academic coursework with a 6-semester credit hour internship in the Dallas-Fort Worth (DFW) metroplex.

The ICL benefits UT Dallas by providing students with the opportunity for professional and civic development while deepening the university's ties to the broader DFW community and continuing to support its brand of excellence in higher education.

Course Requirements:

Select two from the following courses:

[PSCI 4335](#) Institutions Within State and Local Government

[PSCI 4336](#) Civic Engagement and Participation

[PPOL 4311](#) Wicked Social Problems

[PPOL 4305](#) Policy Analysis, Theory, and Methods

A 6 semester credit hour internship within the DFW metroplex with a government agency or nonprofit organization is also required.

[PSCI 4V37](#) Initiative for Civic Leadership Internship (6 Semester Credit Hours)

1. A Core Curriculum Requirement that also fulfills a Major Requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in the Core Curriculum.
2. Most students take upper-division PSCI courses. However, subject to advisor approval, courses from other disciplines may be used to satisfy this requirement.

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